

FAQs

AICTE Productization Fellowship (APF)

Q1. What is AICTE Productization Fellowship (APF) and what is the Idea behind it?

The APF aims to support students in developing innovative products and services that solve societal problems or introduce novel solutions to the market. It provides financial support for those ideas with proof-of-concept (PoC) for taking it further for product development and commercialization.

Q2. Who are eligible for AICTE Productization Fellowship (APF)?

Full-time undergraduate, postgraduate, or doctoral students from AICTE-approved institutions are eligible and Passed out Student/ Students from AICTE approved Institutions / University Departments within TWO years from the completion of their Course/Program are also eligible. Teams can include up to 3 members (4 in exceptional cases).

Q3. Can an individual student or a group of students apply for the fellowship?

Yes. Individual students or groups of students up to 3 members (4 in exceptional cases), enrolled in any program (or) courses approved by AICTE, are eligible to apply for this fellowship.

Q4: Can a student or a team of students submit more than one innovative product development project for support?

No. Only one innovative product development project proposal per student (or) students team will be supported for a minimum of one year. This support is applicable during their tenure in the current academic program at the Higher Education Institution (HEI) (or) after completion—provided they remain associated with an incubation center at any AICTE-approved institution.

Q5. What type of project ideas are accepted?

Only those projects that have reached at least the **Proof of Concept (PoC)** stage will be considered. Simple ideas without any development or validation are **not** eligible.

Q6. Can a team with members from different colleges apply?

Yes! A team can include students from different AICTE-approved colleges/university departments, but each student must get a bonafide certificate from their own college/university to confirm their eligibility.

Q7. When and how can someone apply for APF?

You can apply **anytime during the year** through the AICTE online portal. However, proposals are evaluated **twice a year as per timelines, notified from time to time**.

Q8. How long does the student or team of students can avail the fellowship?

The fellowship is for **one year** and can be extended for **another one year** if the project shows good progress in terms of prototype and enters the next stage of development of a prototype and advancement toward a market-ready product.

Q9. What kind of financial support is provided?

- ₹37,000 per month per student for up to one year in Stage 1
- ₹37,000 per month per student for another one year in Stage 2 (If the prototype of the product is successfully completed.)
- A contingency grant of ₹50,000 per year per team to cover tools, materials, or other expenses

Q10. Can I get other scholarships or internships while on this fellowship?

No. If you are getting any other financial support (like a salary, scholarship, or internship (more than 3 month)), you can't receive APF funds at the same time. You must inform AICTE if this happens.

Q11. What happens if a student joins a job during the fellowship?

The fellowship will be terminated from the date of joining the job, and cannot be resumed later. The main purpose of this fellowship is to encourage students to become entrepreneur (job provider not job seeker)

Q12. Who evaluates the proposals?

An **expert committee** constituted by AICTE assesses each proposal on merit. The decision of the competent authority is final.

Q13. What if a student's progress is unsatisfactory?

If quarterly progress is **"Not satisfactory,"** the fellowship will be **discontinued** from the next quarter.

Q14. How many teams are selected each year?

- In stage 1 total 500 teams will be selected
- In stage 2 total 150 teams will be selected

Q15. What is the disbursement method for funds?

Funds are transferred directly to the student's Aadhaar-seeded bank account via Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT).

Q16. Who owns the intellectual property developed during the fellowship?

Commercial and patent rights will be **jointly held** by the student(s) and the institution.

Q17. What are the roles and responsibilities of the university/institute under the AICTE APF Scheme?

- Nodal Officer Appointment: Assign a faculty member as the Nodal Officer to serve as the primary point of contact between the university/institute and AICTE for all operational aspects of the scheme.
- Student Support: Actively encourage students to engage in innovation and product development or service-related activities aligned with the APF Scheme guidelines. Provide support for student projects through access to infrastructure, incubators, and advanced laboratory facilities.
- Portal Updates: Update the AICTE online portal with student/team details, including their bank accounts linked with Aadhaar numbers.
- Progress Reporting: Approve progress reports of the selected students or teams via the AICTE portal to disbursement of the fellowship directly to their accounts through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT).
- Notification of Discontinuation: Immediately report any discontinuation or cancellation of a student or team from the scheme on the designated AICTE portal. Fellowship may be discontinued or canceled based on specific reasons outlined by AICTE.

Q18. Is there a provision for mentorship or industry support through AICTE?

No. There is no direct provision from AICTE. However, individual students or student teams are encouraged to seek guidance from mentors available within their institute (or) industry (or) any other external sources without any financial support from AICTE.

Q19. Where and how can I apply for the AICTE Productization Fellowship (APF)?

To apply for the AICTE Productization Fellowship (APF), visit (<https://apf.aicte.gov.in/>) and complete the registration process. Once registered, log in to your account, fill out the required form, and submit your application.

For more information along with detailed instructions, please refer to the Scheme document and user manual available on the AICTE website at (<https://www.aicte-india.org/schemes/students-development-schemes>).